THE BLACKWOOD RIDGE MYSTERIES

Some books hide their darkest secrets in the margins.

When a reclusive town historian is found poisoned at a rare book auction in the misty Blue Ridge foothills, antiquarian bookshop owner Callie Thorne is the only one who notices what the police missed: a coded message handwritten in the victim's catalog.

For Callie, marginalia isn't just an academic curiosity — it's a gift. Decoding the faded notes tucked inside old volumes is what she does better than anyone. But this time the trail leads far deeper than a single murder. Every note points toward a decades-old scandal buried in Blackwood Ridge's founding families.

The sheriff sees a meddling shopkeeper. The killer sees a threat that needs silencing. With an innocent man already in the crosshairs, Callie faces an impossible choice: let a killer walk free, or expose the truth and watch her community shatter.

"Smart, atmospheric bookish mystery with real emotional stakes."

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THE ANNOTATED MURDER

VESPER BLYTHE

THE BLACKWOOD RIDGE MYSTERIES • BOOK 1

The ANNOTATED MURDER



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